

WOMAN 'CRUSOE' LIVED 20 YEARS ON ISLAND

(By Science Service).

SANTA MONICA, Cal.—The story of a woman "Robinson Crusoe" who lived alone on an island for twenty years is told by Dr. Roy L. Moodie, who has been delving into the records of old native life in this region in his study of prehistoric diseases in America.

The feminine Crusoe had been a member of a small group of Indians which lived on San Nicolas Island, off the California coast, about a hundred years ago. The Spanish fathers persuaded the group to leave their lonely island and find better protection at the Santa Barbara Mission. But this woman refused to come.

All alone she demonstrated her self-sufficiency in the world by making her home of whale ribs and brush, and by living off the abundant fish, abalones, birds, seals, and some plant products. She made her clothing of bird skins. When at last she was brought to the mission she died within six weeks.

The island possesses many relics of aboriginal life, but none so romantic as the record of the lost woman, Dr. Moodie said.